CHANGEPOND

Enterprise Email Automation Proposal — Outlook Limitation, Proof, and Azure Logic Apps Solution

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1. Executive Summary

The current automation solution using **Outlook triggers in Power Automate** is not suitable for enterprise email processing where **approximately 30% of emails contain attachments up to 75 MB**.

Microsoft does **not guarantee or support reliable automation for large emails using Outlook connectors**. This creates a material risk of **missed emails, failed triggers, and operational disruption**.

To ensure enterprise-grade reliability, Microsoft's recommended architecture is **Azure Logic Apps integrated with Microsoft Graph API**, which is designed to **securely and reliably process large emails and attachments**.

2. Core Challenge

Business Requirement

- Process incoming emails automatically
- Support **emails up to 75 MB**
- Ensure **high reliability and enterprise SLAs**

Technical Constraint

Outlook-based automation **cannot reliably process or certify emails of this size** due to **Microsoft platform limitations**, not implementation issues.

3. Proof: Why Outlook & Power Automate Cannot Be Certified for 75-MB Emails

Key Fact

Even if a 75-MB email is successfully sent or received in Outlook, **Power Automate Outlook triggers are not guaranteed to process it**.

Reasons (Microsoft Platform Limitations)

- Outlook connectors impose **payload and attachment processing limits**
- Large attachments may:
  - Prevent triggers from firing
  - Be excluded from the flow payload
  - Cause silent failures or timeouts
- Microsoft provides **no SLA or certification guarantee** for large-email automation using Outlook triggers

Important Clarification

Receiving an email in Outlook does NOT mean it can be reliably automated using Outlook connectors.

Therefore, **we cannot certify Outlook automation for 75-MB emails**, because the platform **does not guarantee consistent, repeatable results**.

4. Microsoft's Recommended Enterprise Approach

Microsoft recommends using **server-side APIs** instead of mailbox-level connectors for enterprise workloads.

Recommended Stack

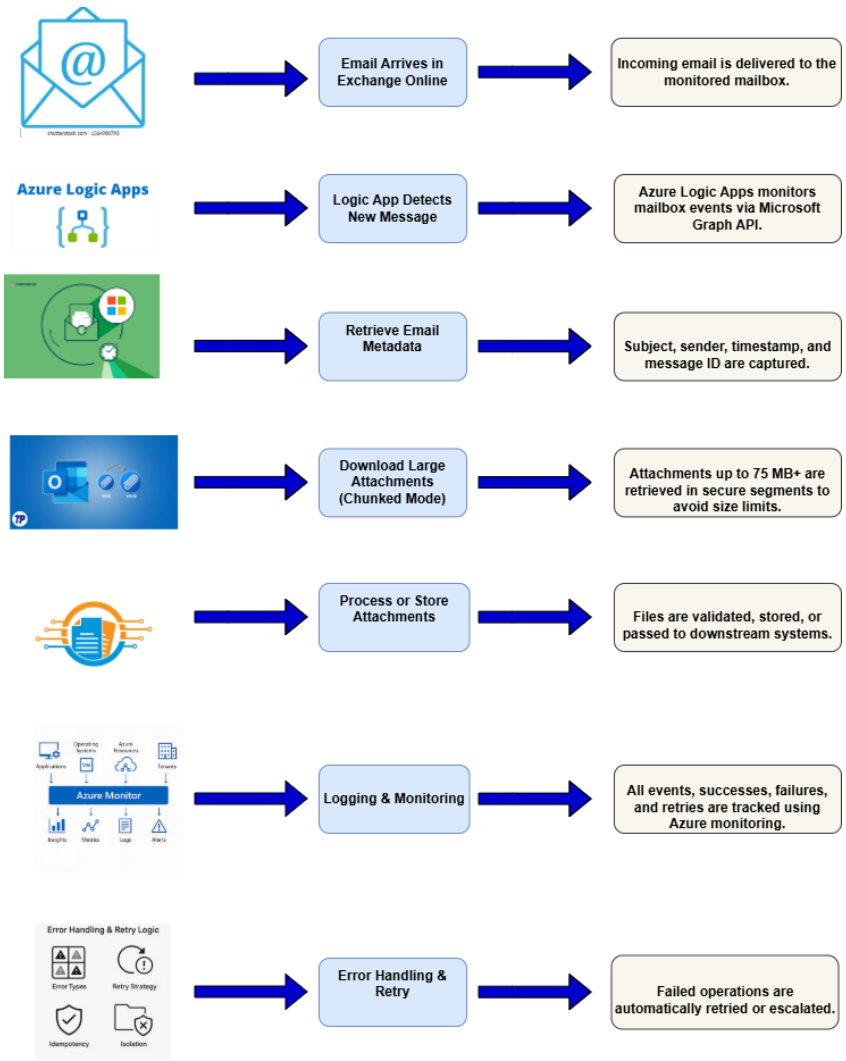
- **Azure Logic Apps** — workflow orchestration
- **Microsoft Graph API** — secure, server-side access to Exchange Online

This approach is designed to:

- Support **large attachments**
- Enable **chunked upload/download**
- Provide **predictable, enterprise-grade behavior**

5. Proposed Solution Architecture

High-Level Flow



Step 1 — Email Arrives in Exchange Online

Incoming email is delivered to the monitored mailbox.

Step 2 — Logic App Detects New Message

Azure Logic Apps monitors mailbox events via Microsoft Graph API.

Step 3 — Retrieve Email Metadata

Subject, sender, timestamp, and message ID are captured.

Step 4 — Download Large Attachments (Chunked Mode)

Attachments up to **75 MB+** are retrieved in secure segments to avoid size limits.

Step 5 — Process or Store Attachments

Files are validated, stored, or passed to downstream systems.

Step 6 — Logging & Monitoring

All events, successes, failures, and retries are tracked using Azure monitoring.

Step 7 — Error Handling & Retry

Failed operations are automatically retried or escalated.

6. Key Benefits to the Organization

Reliable Handling of Large Emails

- Supports **75 MB+ attachments**
- No Outlook connector size constraints
- Microsoft-supported enterprise pattern

Enterprise Reliability & Scalability

- Automatic retries
- High-volume parallel processing
- No dependency on individual mailboxes

Security & Compliance

- OAuth 2.0 authentication via Azure AD
- Least-privilege access
- Full audit logging
- Alignment with enterprise security controls

Monitoring & Auditability

- End-to-end tracking

- Error diagnostics
- Operational transparency

Cost & Operational Efficiency

Capability	Outlook / Power Automate	Azure Logic Apps
75-MB email support	Not reliable	Supported
Enterprise scalability	Limited	High
Error handling	Basic	Advanced
Microsoft enterprise recommendation	No	Yes

7. Business Justification for Migration

If We Stay on Outlook Automation

- Risk of **missed critical emails**
- Manual recovery required
- Unsupported enterprise scenario
- Future re-architecture inevitable

If We Move to Logic Apps + Graph API

- **Guaranteed scalability**
- Microsoft-aligned architecture
- Future-proof solution
- Reduced operational risk

8. Transparent Trade-Offs

Initial Setup Effort

- Azure resource provisioning
- Application permissions setup
- One-time configuration effort

Skills & Governance

- Requires Azure DevOps & monitoring discipline

Mitigation: These are **one-time investments** that significantly reduce long-term operational risk.

9. Client-Safe Proof Statement (Ready to Use)

"Microsoft does not support or guarantee Outlook or Power Automate triggers for processing large emails such as 75 MB. Even if such an email is received, the connector cannot reliably process or

certify it. Microsoft's recommended enterprise solution for this requirement is Azure Logic Apps integrated with Microsoft Graph API."

10. Final Recommendation

We recommend proceeding with **Azure Logic Apps + Microsoft Graph API** as the **enterprise-grade, Microsoft-supported solution** for large-email automation.

This ensures:

- Reliability
- Scalability
- Security
- Long-term sustainability
- Alignment with Microsoft best practices